

▼ RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **FAMILY SUPPORT WORKER** Works with at-risk families to provide practical and emotional support, such as caring for children whose parents are divorcing or apart due to a prison sentence.
- ▶ **HOUSING OFFICER/MANAGER** Works for social housing associations and rehabilitative housing projects, providing on-site advice and support to residents and specific vulnerable groups, such as the homeless, minority groups, ex-offenders, or disabled people.
- ▶ **LIFE COACH** Provides impartial and confidential advice to individuals suffering from a variety of social, financial, legal, and employment problems. Life coaches can also mediate on behalf of a client, for example by writing letters or attending tribunals.

SKILLS GUIDE



Excellent interpersonal skills and emotional maturity for relating to young people and their problems.



The ability to work closely with other professionals, such as police, teachers, and probation officers.



Creative skills for organizing activities that build young people's self-esteem and personal skills.



Good written and verbal skills for producing reports for funding, regulatory, or community groups.



Strong self-management skills for handling a number of different cases at the same time.

SUBSTANCE ABUSE WORKER

Supports individuals seeking to overcome a dependency on illegal, prescription, or over-the-counter drugs and alcohol. Also provides referrals to other professionals, such as social workers, to plan a recovery and treatment program.



STUDENT COUNSELOR Provides support and structured therapy to help young people overcome emotional and social problems that may affect their studies. Counselors usually work in a student-services department at a school, college, or university.



YOUTH WORKER You may work with teenagers and young adults in areas that suffer from high unemployment and limited opportunities. With experience, you can move into management roles.



YOUTH/COMMUNITY CENTER LEADER Organizes sports, arts, drama, and other activities at a local youth club, community center, or faith center. Leaders also develop and run projects that help young people deal with issues such as bullying or drug abuse.